

"In Him was life."

... THE ...

"I will come again."

Bible Standard.

"The Gift of God is Eternal Life."

VOL. 36. No. 5.

AUCKLAND, N.Z., MAY, 1916.

THREEPENCE.

Let God be True.

Anzac Day has afforded occasion for a further outbreak of false, foolish, and harmful sentiment with regard to our soldiers who have been killed upon the field of battle. At a meeting in Auckland, the Anglican Bishop is reported as saying:—"Thanks to the Easter message, we are confident that the brave men who will not come back to us have not finished their life of devotion, but have gone into God's higher camp of service, where He has special work for each one of them. . . . Death for them is not the end; it is but the introduction to fuller life and increased powers."

We honour the brave men who have responded to the call, and have yielded their lives in the cause of duty, but that sentiment must not be suffered to deny the Word of God and to usurp the prerogative of Divine revelation.

We state, positively, that there is no authority whatever for the ideas:—

(1) That men enter into God's "higher camp of service" because they died as soldiers. We concede the righteousness of the cause for which they died, but the Divine conditions for man's salvation, clearly revealed and declared, do not contain this idea as a means. We conclude that unless the soldier possessed the Bible plea his self-sacrifice is not a passport.

(2) That the soldiers are dead and alive at the same time. It is certain that they died; evidence is wanted to show that they are now alive. We know of nothing in Scripture to warrant the idea.

(3) That "the Easter Message" has any relationship whatever to a conscious death-state. If there is such a thing as resurrection from the dead, it must be because it is necessary, but it has never yet been successfully shown that resurrection is necessary, if life, consciousness, and service can continue when the organism is dead. If death is the introduction to fuller life and increased powers, why a resurrection? O, Consistency!

Moral.—Even the word of a Bishop must not be taken if it opposes Scripture.

Notes for the Month.

Anzac Day.

We remember our dead. We recall the day when they went out from us in the possession of life and vigour, resolved to do and to dare for the sake of the Empire against unrighteous aggressions. They went into the baptism of fire and blood and gave their lives for the cause. In these lands of the South, and in the Homeland their heroism is sung, and their devotion to the Empire is lauded. It is well thus to recall what they have done, but let it not be forgotten that they are dead. They are mourned by those who loved them. Many homes have been saddened by the loss of a son, a brother, a husband, and in our midst are those who are maimed for life. We praise the heroism of our "boys," but the war exists, and is a testimony to something more than itself. The celebration of Anzac Day is an evidence of the helplessness of man in face of the red riot let loose upon the world. It is the token of man's incapacity to rule for human benefit, the while he lusts for wider realms. Let that thought find a place in our minds as we remember our heroic lads, and possibly it may lead to the consideration of the necessity for the Divine Kingdom to be ruled over by the Prince of Peace.

Superstition and the War.

The existence and continuance of the war and its attendant horrible slaughter has let loose a flood of spurious sentiment from would-be theologians. Having dropped the old ideas of eternal misery for all who die out of Christ as no longer defensible, but still holding to the pagan notion of soul-immortality, they have been compelled by the force of events to consider the question of the state of those who, in the service of their country, have sacrificed their lives. As we read the current ideas we learn that it seems generally accepted that those who are killed in battle on the side of the Allies will be saved because they are fighting on the side of righteousness. This is a new method of salvation, of which, we may remark, the Bible seems to know nothing. A Dr. Jones, of England, has published a booklet on *The Great Hereafter*, in which he presents the conclusion that many killed upon the field of battle may have been instantaneously converted at the moment of death; but if not, then there will be opportunity afforded afterwards, which is, of course, a reintroduction to Protestantism of the doctrine of Purgatory. All such talk or writing is just so

much evidence that the doctrine of soul-immortality is a thing so wholly out of harmony with Bible truth that in order to continue to hold it men must invent other doctrines to support it. One lie demands others to keep it alive.

Spiritism and the Dead.

But it must not be forgotten that our theologians are not having matters all their own way. Other views obtain, and are put forward with certainty. When Mr. Leadbeater, the Theosophical lecturer, was in Auckland, he told his hearers, as a stupendous fact, that those who were hurried to the astral plane by death on the battlefield were being looked after by a guide specially appointed for the purpose, and he assured them that special benefits would accrue to those who had given their lives for their country. But even his authority does not settle the question, for the Spiritists also have a say. A London weekly paper says:—"We have received a spiritualistic pamphlet which claims to give the latest evidence of psychic science on death, by a professional medium. There is a crude reproduction of a man's soul leaving the body, and a detailed description of all that happens after death to a soldier killed on the battlefield. This includes a fancy picture of a 'spiritual' hospital, smiling nurses, a 'spiritual' house of rest, 'decorated' very much as a home in England might be, with books, easy chairs, and musical instruments." The author further explains that religious observances and opinions have no effect on the future state, and that by joining a spiritualist or theosophical society you may enter "the communion of saints."

A Choice of Views.

What with the varying theological notions on the state of the dead soldiers, ranging from the view of an immediate salvation and entrance into glory, on the ground that they gave their lives in service for others, to the dubious purgatory of opportunity for salvation, and the somewhat discrepant notions of spiritists and theosophists, there seems to be plenty of choice. It is all very confusing, for these ideas cannot all be true; if one is true then all others are false, and the possibility is that all are false. Possibility? Nay, all are misleading, for all rest upon the common supposition that the man can go on living when he is dead. Instead of investigating the claims of these varied views on the conscious state of the dead, it were more profitable to enquire as to the nature of man, and that question settled according to the Bible, science,

and common-sense, it would be known that the Anzac heroes, together with their foes, the fallen Turks, alike sleep upon Gallipoli in utter unconsciousness till the resurrection. This is good Bible doctrine, it is simple and comforting, and it saves us from the distracting mental effort to harmonise the irreconcilable.

Mass in the Auckland Domain.

Recently the Roman Catholics of Auckland had a field day. They secured the Domain for their purpose, and there celebrated the Mass. This produced a correspondence in the Public Press questioning the wisdom of the Council in letting the Domain for such a purpose. The Council disclaimed all responsibility, affirming that the matter of celebrating the Mass was not submitted to them. That being accepted, it is still a question whether they are wholly clear of responsibility in the matter. The Mass is viewed by Protestants as an outward and visible act of idolatry, and it is surely quite right to say that no responsible body of men can, in a Protestant community, grant the use of public property for the celebration of that which is against the convictions of the many. If they unwittingly or thoughtlessly grant such use, then, when attention is called to it, there should be some expression of regret that advantage had been taken of a privilege. To say that the use of the Domain was also granted to the Salvation Army is to compare two things that differ widely. Such comparison does not reflect much credit on the wisdom of the Council which puts it forward as an excuse and a testimony to their tolerance.

Indignant Council.

The celebration of Mass in the Domain, and the reception given to the Papal Legate by the Mayor, called forth a protest from the Orangemen of the city, and an open letter was circulated voicing the protest, and calling the Mayor to task for his action. At the Council meeting a resolution was passed expressing sympathy with the Mayor, and condemning the spirit of bigotry manifested in the letter. The resolution reads well, and no doubt there was much virtuous indignation expressed. But it may be here said that the resolution does not alter the fact that the Papal Legate is something more than a prominent official of a Church organisation. By virtue of his office he represents a Court which claims to have temporal jurisdiction over all peoples, and that this is Divinely given. If it be said that this is theory only and not now existent fact, it must be answered that the

claims of the Romish Court are the same as ever. History records what it did when it had the power, and its present action, where it has authority, as in South America, is like to that of its past. There is abundant evidence of its continual scheming to again obtain control over Britain. For some years past the Kaiser and Pope have been good friends, with one object in view. But, passing by all that, What of the attitude of the Roman Curia to the Allies in this present war? We intern those amongst us who are suspected of enemy tendencies, and then our Mayor gives a welcome to a Legate who represents a Court so manifestly in favour of our foes that it has no word of condemnation for the sufferings of those of its own faith, because of its hopes in the ultimate success of the Central Powers.

A Pro-German Curia.

Even British Catholics charge the Vatican with pro-German sympathies. Not long since the English *Tablet* rebuked the official organ of the Vatican for the manner in which it found excuses for German outrages. The Belgian Catholics have laid their case before the Vatican, and the findings of the Commissions which have investigated these matters are in print, together with the German White Paper, but the Pope still holds himself from any word of condemnation on the atrocities committed on a harmless people. The benevolent Father claims to be neutral, but leans hard over on the German side. The attitude is distinct enough, and has a meaning. "Writing in a recent issue of the Vienna *Reichspost*, Herr Ersberger, the leader of the Roman Catholic party in the German Reichstag, who a few weeks ago was publicly thanked by the Pope for his services to the Holy See, says: 'In consequence of the war of 1870, the Pope lost Rome, and so arrived at his present unworthy status. The war of 1915 offers an opportunity of restoring full freedom and independence to his Holiness.' It is, of course, made clear by the writer that this end can only be attained by the Pope's reliance upon the Central Powers." — (*Bulwark*.) These things being so, what value should be attached to the resolution of the City Council, and how should we view the reception accorded by the Mayor of a free people to the Papal Legate?

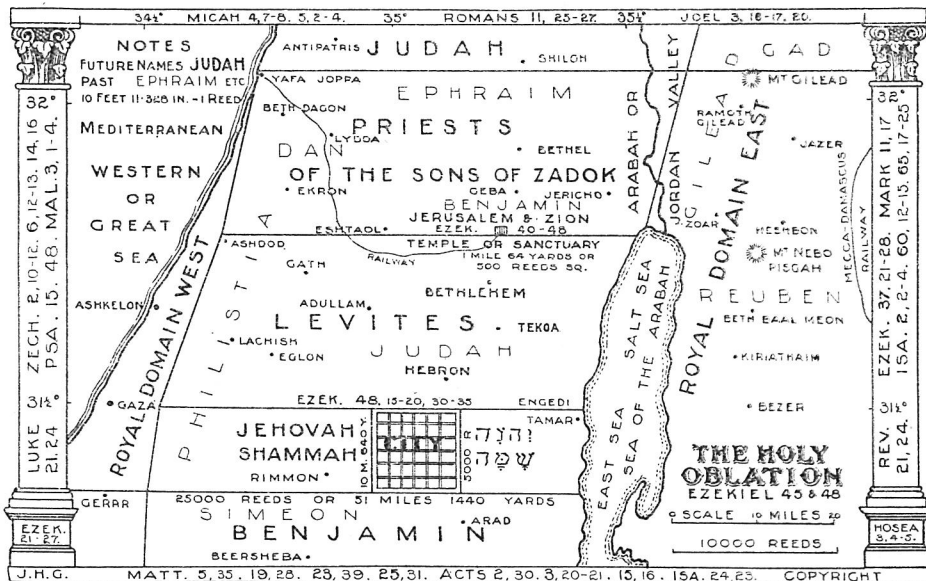
When Mr Spurgeon was asked how he would defend the Bible, he said: "I would no more think of defending the Bible than of defending a lion; turn him loose and he will defend himself."

THE HOLY OBLATION.

(Concluded.)

God has appointed a day of a thousand years, the seventh thousand years from the creation of Adam, the last or seventh day, in which He will judge or rule the world in righteousness by the Man whom He has ordained. The resurrection of this Man from among the dead, whom God raised up for the very purpose of setting Him on the throne of His forefather David, at the set time to favour Zion—when He will appear in His glory, which is “the Blessed Hope”—is an assurance that the promise will be fulfilled (Acts ii. 30, xvii. 31; Psalms cii. 13-22; Titus ii. 13; 2 Peter iii. 3-10). God will send Jesus, the

miles, is to be turned like the Arabah, or Jordan Valley (Zech. xiv. 10, R.V.), Eshtaol, Ekron, Lod or Lydda (where Peter healed the palsied Aeneas), Beth-Dagon, Gezer, Beth-Horon, upper and lower, Gibeon, etc. Shiloh (where the tabernacle and the ark of God were for between 300 and 400 years—Jer. vii. 11-15) was just beyond the north boundary, in the future apportionment to Judah. Within the Levites’ portion are Bethlehem (the birthplace of the Messiah, Who was “born to be King of the Jews” and “over all the earth” (Micah v. 2-4; Matt. ii. 1-6, xxiii. 37-39; John i. 49-51, xviii. 33-37; Zech. ix. 9, 10, xiv. 9, 16-21; Isa. ii. 1-4; Psalms ii.; Heb. i. 6-9, R.V., ii. 5-8), Hebron (where Abraham lived for some time (Gen. xiii. 18, xviii. 1, xxiii. 2), and he and



Christ or Messiah, at the times of restitution, restoration, *apokatastasis*, renovation, or re-establishment of all things pertaining to David's throne and kingdom, of which He has spoken by the mouth of His holy prophets (Acts i. 6-11, ii. 34, 35, iii. 19-26, xiii. 34; 1 Sam. ii. 1-10; 2 Sam. vii., xxiii. 1-7; Psalms ii. lxxii., lxxxix., cx., cxxxii.; Ezek. xxxvii. 21-28; Amos ix. 11-15).

The Holy Oblation will occupy the ancient territory of Benjamin and parts of Judah, Ephraim, Simeon, Dan, and Philistia. In the Priests' division there are, besides Jerusalem and Joppa (where Peter raised Dorcas to life), the sites of Bethel (near which Abraham built an altar to Jehovah (Gen. xii. 8) and the place of Jacob's dream (Gen. xxviii. 10-22), Jericho, Geba (from which to Rimmon, a distance of 36

Sarah, Isaac and Rebecca, and Jacob and Leah were buried (Gen. xxiii., xxv. 7-10, xxxv. 27-29, xlix. 31, l. 13), and where David reigned for the first seven years of his reign, prior to his conquest of Zion, where he reigned for 33 years (1 Kings ii. 11). Tekoa, Adullam, Eglon, Lachish, Gath, Beth-Shemesh, Kiriath-Jearim, and Ashdod, or Azotus (where Philip was found after the Spirit caught him away from the Ethiopian whom he had baptised on the Jerusalem to Gaza Road (Acts viii. 26-40), which was typical of the catching away of all baptised believers of the truth at the coming of the Lord (Acts viii. 12; Gal. iii. 26, 27; 1 Thess. iv. 13-18). In "the possession of the city" are the sites of Engedi, or Tamar, on the western side of the Dead Sea, whence the eastern boundary

line of the five southern tribal portions runs southward as far as Kadesh (Ezek. xlvii. 19) and Rimmon to the west of "the city," which latter will cover the sites of Carmel, Maon, Ziph, Jutah, Jattir, Kain, Eshtemoa, Socoh, Anab, Kerioth, Jezreel, Dumah, etc. (Josh. xv. 48-55), on the mountains of Judah, in a district celebrated for its vineyards, figs, pomegranates, etc., and only a few miles south of Eshcol, where the spies obtained the large bunch of grapes that required two men to carry it (Num. xiii. 23).

It was in this neighbourhood, and S.W. of it—between Hebron, Beersheba, Gerar and Beer-Lahai-roi—that Abraham spent the greater part of the time of his sojourning in the land of Promise (Gen. xiii. 18, xvi. 14, xviii. 1, xx. 1, xxi. 31, xxiv. 62). Here also Isaac and Jacob were born, and Isaac lived the whole of his life and Jacob a great part of his (Gen. xxv. 26, xxvi. 1, 17-23, xxviii. 10, xxxv. 27, xxxvii. 1, xlvii. 1). From the neighbourhood of Beersheba Abraham went, past Hebron and Bethlehem, to Mount Moriah, which was about three days' journey, to offer up Isaac (Gen. xxi. 33, 34, xxii. 1-4). On this mount Solomon's Temple was afterwards erected (2 Chron. iii. 1), and this site will be included in the Temple of the Greater than Solomon—"the House of the God of Jacob"—to which all nations shall go in the Millennial Age to worship the King, the Lord of Hosts; and sacrifices will again be offered with acceptance upon the altar (Zech. vi. 12, 13; xiv. 16-21; Isa. ii. 2, 3, lvi. 7, lx. 7-15; Ezek. xl.-xlviii; Haggai ii. 3-9; Mal. iii. 1-4; Mark xi. 17; Matt. xxiii. 37-39). And when this Temple will be built Abraham will be again in the land of his sojournings, which was promised for an "everlasting possession" to him and his seed, or Christ and all who are Christ's, in whom all nations shall be blessed, and the Temple of Jehovah, both personal and architectural, shall be in the midst of Israel *for evermore* (Gen. xvii. 7, 8; Gal. iii. 8, 16, 29; Matt. xxii. 31, 32; Acts vii. 2-5, xxvi. 6-8; Rom. iv. 13; John ii. 21; 1 Cor. vi. 19; 2 Cor. vi. 16; Eph. ii. 19-22; 1 Peter ii. 1-10; Ezek. xxxvii. 21-28, xxxix. 25-29). We await with joyous anticipation the arrival of this glorious time: for the Kingdom, for the coming of which the Messiah taught His disciples to pray, will then have come, wars will cease to the end of the earth, righteousness and peace will be universal, and the song of the angels at the birth of Jesus of Nazareth will be realised—"Glory to God in the highest and peace on earth, goodwill among men" (Matt. vi. 10; Psal. xlvii. 9, lxxii.; Luke ii. 14). Then David's greater Son and Lord

will reign "for the ages" in David's presence, on David's throne, on Mount Zion in Jerusalem (2 Sam. vii. 12-16; Psal. ii. 6, xvii. 15, cx.; Isa. ix. 6, 7, xxiv. 23, lxxv. 17-25; Luke i. 32-33, xxi. 24; Jer. iii. 14-18; Matt. v. 35, xxii. 41-46, xxiii. 37-39), and the covenants made with Abraham and David will be fulfilled (Eph. ii. 12, iii. 1-6; Gen. xxii. 17, 18; Psal. lxxxix.; Heb. xi. 8, 9, 10, 13, 39, 40).

"Hail to the Lord's Anointed!

Great David's Greater Son;

Hail! in the time appointed.

His reign *on earth* begun.

He comes to break oppression.

To set the captive free;

To take away transgression,

To rule in equity."

J.H.G.

WHY I BELIEVE IN SICKNESS AND TROUBLE.

Not because I want to, but because I have to. Because I believe in quinine, which isn't half so sweet as sugar, but is a much better febrifuge. Because I don't believe that an athlete can train for a Marathon race on ice cream and soda and fudge. Because I don't believe that pickle and cake are good muscle-builders for the tennis and basket ball girl. Because I believe that the greatest victory of the Revolutionary war was Valley Forge. I believe in the strengthening discipline of sickness and trouble because men don't go to a rose garden to look for ship timber. I believe that Napoleon was defeated by his succession of victories while Wellington was victorious through his many defeats. Because I believe that America was discovered while a starving navigator was being turned away from palace doors under the smarting scourge of scientific geographers. Because I believe a man who never had an ache never had a pleasure. Because a horse that is allowed to feed himself from the bin and have the run of the pasture never wins a race. Because I believe in the old Arab proverb, "All sunshine makes the desert." Because a snow-fed river lasts through the summer drought. Because Jacob saw a vision that all the world still looks at, when his head was pillowed on a stone in the desert. Because David learned to govern Egypt in the cave of Adullam, and Joseph learned high statecraft in an Egyptian prison. Because people who get everything they want and get it easy, die crying for the moon. Because I believe in this "world ye shall have tribulation."—*Selected.*

Echoes from West Street

"HE IS RISEN."

Readers of the Gospels will notice that in each of the synoptic narratives, roughly about half the space is occupied with the story of the last few days of the Lord's life on earth. When John writes his record he gives an independent account of the death of Christ, which covers from the twelfth chapter to the close of the book. The space occupied shows the importance attached to the events which lead up to, and culminate in, the death of Christ.

But the history of Christ did not end there. We look upon the sad procession to Calvary and note the death upon the Cross, thence we follow the faithful few who bear the Crucified One to the tomb, and see the stone rolled in front, and the official seal placed upon it. In the record of any other man that would be the end. The story might be followed by helpful reflections on the life-work of the deceased, and the influence following from deed and example, but the actual history of a man closes when the grave closes upon him. But these Evangelists who wrote the story of Jesus, all agree in carrying that history further. With the like calmness and care shown when they chronicle His life amongst men, they go on to record that He rose from the dead. Further, that which they put down as having happened in the domain of fact thenceforward becomes the centre around which their lives and labours circled. In a word, the Resurrection of Christ is the central, pivotal fact of New Testament history and doctrine.

Eastertide is again with us, and the date suggests that this topic is in place for our columns in this issue. Let us see if there are not some helpful thoughts for our meditation. As a starting point, we declare that, apart from the fact of the Resurrection of Christ from the dead, there is no ground for Christianity. If that event did not occur, all of the recorded Divine preparation is valueless, and, an apostle being witness, we are of all men most pitiable, there is no hope for any.

It may be fairly said that if the miraculous element were removed from the Gospels they would be received by all as records of historical facts. If we consider them as such, and examine their plan, then the proposition is yielded that the very structure and design of these historical narratives demand for their completion the resurrection of the Lord from the dead.

Many are ready to affirm that they can accept the moral teaching of the gospels without burdening themselves with the miraculous element, especially with the resurrection of Christ. The character of Christ is admired, and He is placed in the Valhalla of good men, whose characters and lives are to be emulated and improved upon. But, if the reader will ask, what is the revealed scope of the gospel story? he will find that its beginning and progress are marked by statements which declare that a great issue is to follow from the advent of Jesus amongst men. A wave of blessing then began which should flow onward until all the nations had experienced the designed beneficent result.

A careful reading of the history of Christ's work amongst men will supply the details which show the manner in which it operates to impart blessing to mankind. The Lord insists that man is a lost and needy creature, but He equally insists that the salvation He has brought nigh will meet every need of man. He carries His religious instructions further than any other teacher has done, and manifests that they are connected with works which are designed to effect the physical well-being of men. These teachings offer to men the gift of eternal life, and the deeds manifest the efficacy of the eternal life upon human nature. Definitely dealing with man as at present, a mortal perishing being, and yet presenting the offer of eternal life to him, the Gospel necessarily predicates a resurrection from the dead in order that the promised life may be possessed. The gospel of the grace of God affirms that such resurrection shall take place, and provides for it by a clearly revealed plan. Note well: If the individual man is to be raised from the dead to eternal life as the issue of belief in the message regarding Jesus Christ, there must be a preceding revelation of the victory over the grave to substantiate the doctrine. The very structure of the Gospel message demands this.

The next point is that the express language of Jesus affirms resurrection from the dead as an essential and integral part of the work which He was sent into the world to accomplish. He came to give Himself a ransom for many, to lay down His life, to draw all men unto Himself. The topic of conversation betwixt the Lord and His heavenly visitants related to the "exodus." He was about to accomplish at Jerusalem. This, however, was not an end. The way to the future before Him was to be travelled via the cross and the tomb. He should be saved "out of death" by a resurrection to life. Travelling that way, He opens it to those who accept Him. This is all in the plan of the history.

Without that end the preliminaries are lacking in point and cohesion, but with it all fall into place and a perfect whole is made.

Next, we note that the historical narratives affirm that His resurrection did take place, and that it occurred according to the prophecies and preparations which went before. It did not happen as if it were an afterthought, but ere yet there seems to be any likelihood of His death by violence, that resurrection is looked forward to as a necessary item in His work for mankind. Each evangelist has apparently in view a special aspect of the Person and work of his Lord. Matthew records the fulfilment of Old Testament prophecy, links Him by genealogy to the fathers to whom the promises were made; makes prominent His kingly aspect, and from first to last he seems to be ever saying, "Behold the King." Matthew declares His resurrection also, and in agreement with his main theme, presents Him as now having "all authority in heaven and on earth." He is the Lawgiver, of the Sermon on the Mount, Who by resurrection from the dead receives "all authority," and Who must be heard, or the rejector of His authority shall "utterly perish." In Mark He is the Servant, the worker of miracles on behalf of men, and when He is risen from the dead, the words of the Evangelist testify that His work continues with the disciples in "the signs following." Luke shows Him as the Man, the Second Man, the beginning of a new humanity, and it is the Risen Man who is vividly before the reader in the events detailed after the Resurrection. Finally, it is John who presents Him as the Son of God, and who records the confession which Thomas makes, evidencing the grasp of this important aspect of the Lord. Let it be here reiterated—the structure of the gospels demands that the resurrection should occur. The language of Jesus teaches that it would take place. When it does happen, as demanded and declared, it is the fitting and only possible culmination. These are the agreeing facts which give the whole significance of the Gospel Story for us.

This prepares for the next step, which is that the resurrection of the Lord is the theme of apostolic ministry. If that proposition is true its establishment will be the condemnation of much that now passes current as gospel preaching. An appeal to the evidence will make the whole subject clear. Whatever the consequences, we must find and hold the truth on this matter. We may not have the whole of his first address delivered by the Apostle Peter, but we have the salient points, and in verses 23-31 lie the convincing argu-

ments presented by the speaker, and they relate to the predicted and the accomplished resurrection. In the next address is the declaration that God raised Him from the dead, and the certification "whereof we are witnesses." On this the Sadducees, being grieved, took action against the disciples "being sore troubled because they taught the people and proclaimed in Jesus the resurrection from the dead." That emphatic testimony which marked the beginning of the Apostolic ministry is the main characteristic all through the history of the Acts; a guide for ourselves, and we dare not depart from the example.

Not only is it the historical fact presented to produce acquiescence with the message delivered, but it is the very kernel of the epistles, and is employed as the incentive in exhortations given for the regulation and conduct of individual and church life. If that truth is removed from its position of prominence in the epistles, then not only is the gospel message deprived of its main feature, but a potent stimulus to Christian conduct is gone. We have not space in this article to enlarge upon this emphatic feature, but commend a careful reading of Paul's letters for the purpose of seeing the place he assigns to this great New Testament doctrine.

Lastly, it is important as an historical fact; important in the gospel message; important in the instructions to the Churches, because it was an actual resurrection of Christ. He arose, for He had died. Do you believe that, or do you believe that it was His body merely that was buried, and afterwards rose from the dead? Be sure as to the facts, for according to your view on this point must be the view held as to the reality of His Resurrection and its value to the whole scheme of redemption. If He—the real Person—did not rise from the dead, but only His body, then He did not die, and the insistence upon the resurrection as the thing to be believed, and to be accepted as the stimulus for service, and as the ground for a future life, seems to us to be wholly unnecessary; but, "CHRIST DIED for our sins," "HE WAS BURIED," "HE HATH BEEN RAISED from the dead." Yes, it is clear, The Resurrection of Christ is a fact, and it is the GREATEST FACT IN THE WORLD'S HISTORY. Hear Him, "I am the Living One; and I became dead, and behold, I am alive for evermore."

"When we see a man going to get water at his neighbour's well we naturally suppose his own is dry. So when we see a Christian seeking the pleasures of the world we suppose he no longer finds pleasure in religion."

Expositions & Studies.

SABBATH VERSUS SUNDAY.

(Concluded from Page 57.)

"On the first day of the week Jesus came and stood in their midst."—JOHN XX. 19.

During the hours of the Jewish Sabbath Jesus remained imprisoned in the cold and silent tomb. But on the first day of the week "the stone was rolled away," and He came forth rescued from the power of death. And it was at a private meeting of the disciples that very evening that the risen Lord suddenly appeared in their midst. It is noteworthy that this first day of the week is the only day of the week that is mentioned by number in all the New Testament (excepting Heb. iv. 4). And doubtless this special honour is conferred upon it because it is the day of the Lord's resurrection. (In the Old Testament this day is sometimes called "the eighth day"—2 Ch. vii. 9).

But we do not find any direct command from God, or instruction from the risen Christ, or admonition from the early Apostles that the first day is to be substituted for the seventh day Sabbath. We find Paul sometimes preaching in the synagogue on the Sabbath (Acts xix. 8), and at other times in an upper room on the first day (Acts xx. 7). Paul conformed to Jewish customs if he could win Jews to Christ; he acted as a Gentile if thereby he might gain Gentiles to the faith (1 Cor. ix. 20-22). He would observe, or not observe, the Jewish Sabbath according to the necessities of the case (Rom. xiv. 5-6; Col. ii. 16-17).

Let us be clear on this point. Though to the Christian *that day*—the first day of the week" (John xx. 19, R.V.) is the most memorable of all days, the "day of days," there is no command or warrant in the New Testament for observing it as "a holy day." To call it "a Christian Sabbath" is a misnomer. There cannot be two Sabbaths, and the Sabbath ordained on Sinai is appointed for the seventh day, and is the *Hebrews'* (or Jewish) Sabbath. And it is this seventh day Sabbath that in the millennial age all the nations of the earth will have to keep sacred unto the Lord—a Sabbath universally regarded and set apart for Divine worship (Is. lvi. 1-7; lxvi. 23). We may honour the first day by laying aside our secular pursuits, and make it "a day of sacred rest"; we may dedicate it to the service and worship of God and so regard it as "the best of days"; but

this is a voluntary act on our part, which may be regarded as an outward mark and token of our affection towards the Christ, and as in remembrance of His glorious resurrection—it being "the resurrection day."

Now we are faced by the fact that only the scattered Jews and a few Gentiles called "Seventh Day Adventists" observe Saturday as being the Sabbath. The great bulk of professing Christians accept the first day as a holy day, and call it "Sunday." Seeing that there is no Scriptural authorisation for this action on the part of Christendom, how is it to be explained? In other words, What is the origin of the Christian Sunday?

As the Church grew in numbers, wealth, influence, power, Christian men felt the need of one day in the week as a day of rest and relief from the monotony and weariness of life, and to ensure opportunity for worship and praise. And in A.D. 321 the Pope and clergy were strong enough to influence the half heathen, half Christian Roman Emperor Constantine, who, at their bidding, made a law commanding cessation of work once a week in all cities and towns of the Roman Empire. And the Roman Church selected the first day of the week in honour of the resurrection of Jesus Christ, the Head of the Church, who rose from His grave on that day. This, in the fewest possible words, is a simple, unvarnished account of the ordering and establishing of our Christian Sunday. In this way a weekly rest was gradually established as a secular as well as a religious institution for all Christendom.

God, through Moses, commanded Israel to keep holy the seventh day. God, through Constantine, by His overruling providence, gave to an overworked and weary world the inestimable privilege, the incalculable boon of a first day's rest. A *command* to Israel. A *privilege* to Gentiles. The Sabbath guarded by a *penalty*. The observance of Sunday *optional*, excepting so far as human laws (Acts of Parliament) restrict and restrain. But all true Christians value the Sunday rest as highly as the devout Jew does his Sabbath rest, and keep jealous and watchful eyes upon those who—whatever their motive—would weaken and destroy the day of blessed rest and opportunity for helpful worship with which God has favoured us.

That the Christian Sunday has its origin in a decree of the Roman Emperor, and is not of Divine command, may be distressing and distasteful to some. But it is a simple fact that cannot be disproved—a statement the correctness of which cannot successfully be challenged. Sunday is not the Sabbath day, and the obser-

vance of Sunday is no more binding upon the Church and world than are Good Friday and Christmas Day.

But it is asserted that the apostle John, in the isle of Patmos, was "in the spirit on the Lord's day," which means that he was engaged in meditation on Sunday, and therefore Sunday must be a day appointed by the Lord and called by His name. But there is no evidence of any kind that "the first day of the week" was ever called "the Lord's day" before the Apocalypse was written. That it was so called *afterwards* is easily understood, and the practice arose through the misinterpretation of these words in Rev. i. 9. The truth is that John in spirit was carried forward, and in vision (as did Ezekiel—chap. xl. 2) saw some of the awful scenes that will be enacted in what the Old Testament calls "the day of the Lord" (Is. ii. 11-12; Joel i. 15; Amos v. 18; Zeph. i. 7; Mal. iv. 5). We are now living in what is called "man's day" (1 Cor. iv. 3, marg.). The coming time of terror which will end man's day is called "the Lord's day." Sunday therefore cannot be the Lord's day.

We hear a great deal just now about the lamentable want of religious observance of the Lord's day, by which is meant the desecration of Sunday. Thousands of people in Auckland (the city near which we write) are out on picnicking excursions every Sunday, steamers and trams being overcrowded with pleasure seekers. Do all these people incur the penalty of everlasting damnation because they have a sail on the ocean on a Sunday? If so, then ministers and Church members who, to suit their own convenience, ride in a train or a tram on Sunday, are under the same condemnation! But, it may be objected, they are simply riding to church. The objection is valueless. Travelling on Sunday is either right or wrong. If it is wrong for the pleasure seeker it is equally wrong for the Church-goer. If it is right for anyone to ride in a public carriage to the place of worship, it is right and lawful for the non-Church-goer to journey to the seaside to spend the day there. Anyhow, tram-riding Christians cannot throw stones at their neighbours for in like manner journeying with their lunch-baskets instead of with Bible and hymn-book. No man will be damned just because he used a public vehicle on Sunday. But if the strict observance of Sunday is a Divine command, he who wilfully breaks it, whether minister or picnicker, will alike have to pay penalty.

The mere outward and formal observance of the Sabbath—whether of a seventh or first day of the week—is nothing to God. To the apos-

tate Hebrews God, through Isaiah, said, "The Sabbath I cannot endure, they are a burden upon Me; I am weary of them" (i. 10-17). If a man's heart is in a state of rebellion, and he is practically an infidel, can it give pleasure to the Almighty if he shall treat as sacred one day in seven? If the man does, it would be mere hypocrisy, a sham; the man will be chafing all the time under a hateful restraint. On the other hand, the true Christian welcomes the providential rest and quiet of the first day of the week. He remembers it is the resurrection day of his Lord and Master. He is glad to meet with the saints in worship. No law compels him, but voluntarily and gladly he spends the sacred hours in thoughts and works that have reference to the life that is to come. The Christian man does not "work righteousness" in order to conform himself to any law (he is only "under law to Christ"—1 Cor. ix. 21). Supposing the ten commands had never been given at Sinai, it would not have altered his character in any wise, for "the love of Christ" would constrain him to what was good and right. The outward observance of Sunday is not commanded by God, is not binding upon any man, but God gladly accepts the voluntary surrender of the day to His service as an act of homage to Himself.

Let no one think we are trying to belittle the day. Thanks to the over-ruling Providence of God, since the year A.D. 321 the first day of the week (Sunday) has been secured to Christendom as a day of rest. Our forefathers maintained and handed this resting day to us as a precious heritage which we highly value, and would hand to our children intact. We therefore enter our most energetic protest against any tampering with the liberty and freedom of this day in the shape of all *unnecessary* Sunday work. Man needs a weekly rest, and only heartless selfishness will rob its fellows of the great boon of Sunday's cessation from toil.

But all this is quite independent of the fourth Sinaitic commandment. If that command is binding upon us as upon the Jewish nation, then the penalty is binding too, and the man who violates "the sanctity of the Sabbath" must be brought forth and *publicly stoned to death*, "as the Lord commanded Moses" (Numb. xv. 32-36), and the witness against him in accordance with that law must cast the first stones (Deut. xvii. 6-7).

Nineteen hundred years ago the apostle Paul was engaged in a sharp controversy as to whether or no the Sabbath must be observed by Christians. By direct inspiration of God he then instructed the Roman Christians as fol-

lows:—"One man esteemeth one day above another: another esteemeth every day alike. Let every man be persuaded in his own mind." And to the Colossian Christians he wrote, "Let no man judge you in meat, or in drink, or in respect of an holy day, or of the new moon, or of the Sabbath."

C. CRISP BROWN.

Devonport.

THE RESURRECTION OF CHRIST.

Notes of a Sermon preached by Edwin Burnham at Worcester, Mass., April 6, 1881.

"But now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept."—1 Cor. xv. 20.

"Why do you preach that Christ has risen from the dead?" "Because I think so," says one. I do not. "Because I believe so," says another. I do not. "Because I feel so," says another. I do not. Such a truth must rest, not upon sentiment, "say so's," pretty songs and baby stories, but upon *evidence* which cannot be refuted.

WHAT ARE THE EVIDENCES OF THE RESURRECTION OF CHRIST?

I. The simple fourfold narrative of the four evangelists, Matthew, Mark, Luke and John, all agreeing in the facts, yet telling their story with such variation that there can be no collusion charged against them.

II. The apostles preached the resurrection of Christ as an indisputable fact, of which they were witnesses. They did not attempt to bring argument to prove it; they told what they saw, and testified what they knew.

III. The learned, wise, and judicious students in the Christian world for eighteen hundred years have accepted this fourfold account of Christ's resurrection.

IV. The unity of the faith of Christendom is another argument. However the different denominations may vary in forms and in creeds, they all believe that Christ is risen.

V. This doctrine has sustained martyrs and believers in persecution and in death. They have lived and died in a hope of resurrection, based upon the resurrection of Christ.

VI. There is monumental evidence. Bunker Hill Monument is a proof that there was a battle of Bunker Hill. Does a man say, "I do not believe there was any such battle"? What is that shaft there for then?

There are four monuments to the resurrection of Christ: First, the weekly rest on the

first day of the week. Second, the Church built upon the faith of Jesus and the resurrection. Third, the Christian literature that has grown out of that fact. Fourth, the ordinances of the Church: the Lord's Supper, telling of His death and baptism, reminding us both of His death and resurrection.

VII. The doctrine of the resurrection has passed through every ordeal, withstood all criticism, and lives to-day in spite of all the efforts of its foes to discredit it.

VIII. The bodily absence of Christ was proof of His resurrection. All admit He died, was laid in the tomb, but His body was not found. Not a bone of it has ever been discovered in Joseph's tomb or anywhere else. He died, was buried, and rose again.

First, He brought divinity from heaven to earth.

Second, He took humanity up to God in heaven.

Third, He is coming back to establish humanity and divinity on earth.

IX. There is no contrary evidence; no proof has ever been brought that Jesus Christ did not rise. A multitude of witnesses testified to His resurrection, and there were none to deny it.

X. The opposing assertions were evidently false and self-contradictory. "While we slept His disciples came and stole Him away." How could they tell what was done while they slept? And if they knew who took Him away, why did they not guard the sepulchre?

XI. The doctrine of the resurrection of the dead is effectual in the regeneration of mankind. Forms do not convert men; ethics do not regenerate them. We must preach Jesus Christ and the resurrection if we would have men saved.

XII. Christ's truthful prophecies as fulfilled are evidences of His resurrection. He foretold the destruction of Jerusalem, and the treading under foot of that city by the Gentiles. He foretold the dispersion of Israel among all nations. He foretold His own death and resurrection. The great prophecies concerning Jerusalem and the nation are fulfilled, and the prediction of His resurrection is also fulfilled.

HOW DOES THIS TRUTH AFFECT US?

I. It inspires faith in the divinity of the Saviour. If He is dead He is not divine. But there is evidence of His divinity: (1) in His incarnation; (2) in the descent of the dove upon His head, and the voice, "This is my beloved Son"; (3) in the miracles He wrought; (4) in the life He lived; (5) the death He died; (6) in His resurrection; (7) in His ascen-

sion: (8) in His presence with His people,—the living Lord dwelling in a living church.

II. The resurrection of Christ strengthens and confirms our faith in the Old Testament. Many prophecies concerning Christ are fulfilled; many others shall yet be fulfilled. Christ is the great centre around which the affairs of the world revolve; even the Grand Turk himself cannot raise money on his bonds till he dates them with *Anno Domini*, "the Year of our Lord." Christ quoted almost every prophet, and His quotation and endorsement give us fresh confidence in those oracles of God.

IV. The resurrection of Christ is the basis of justification by faith. He was raised for our justification. He lives to save you; he has died for your sins. The past is cancelled: The blood of Jesus Christ cleanseth from all sin. The demands are all settled.

V. Belief in the resurrection of Christ gives supplicatory confidence. We come boldly to Him who liveth and was dead, for help.

VI. The resurrection of Christ gives us an assured hope of our own resurrection. He is the head of the body; He rose, and we shall rise; He lives, and we shall live also. He shall change our vile body, that it may be fashioned like unto His glorious body: His word can never fail.

VII. The resurrection of Christ is to us a source of ample and adequate consolation. He does not forget His people in sickness, or in death: He will raise us up at the last day.

VIII. The resurrection of Christ is a motive to Christian activity. He has ascended on high, He lives, and will return. The Church is to watch for Him, as a wife watches for the absent husband; as the soldier watches for the coming of his commander. The soldiers of a great leader feel the mighty power of his glance. Said a Mr. Berrick, who was one of Napoleon's soldiers, "When he looked at me I felt as though God Almighty was looking at me!" If we believe in a living Christ we shall act as under His glance.

IX. Faith in Christ's resurrection gives us hope of a personal vision of Christ: "This same Jesus shall so come in like manner."

X. Faith in Christ's resurrection inspires glorious hope in us. We shall see our Leader; not Caesar, not Alexander, not Napoleon, but the Lord of glory. Of every other leader it was said, "And he died," but of Him it is said, "He shall live."

XI. The resurrection of Christ is the key of prophetic interpretation. The prophecies of His resurrection have been literally fulfilled; other

prophecies shall have similar fulfilment. Heaven and earth shall pass away, but His words shall not pass away.

XII. A belief in the resurrection of Christ gives us faith in Christianity itself. If Christ be not risen, faith is vain, preaching is vain, and we ourselves are found false witnesses of God.—*The Christian*.

TOO LATE.

She kissed the old man; she showered upon him kisses and tears. She told all the people how good he was. I thought if she had only given half a dozen of those kisses a year for the last ten years, how the tender-hearted old gentleman would have smiled through his tears. But now he took it all very coolly. He was dead. He was old and poor, she was young and rich. She had ten rooms, but no room for father. Yet he made room for her when he had only two. The old man was not educated. She was—at his expense. He had fed and clothed her for twenty years at home and at college, until she had risen into more refined and cultured society, and married among new friends. The old people's address and dialect were too coarse. She kissed him and buried him in a beautiful coffin. Dear father is to have a beautiful monument. A warm kiss while living is better than cold marble when dead.—*Young Woman*.

HONEYSUCKLE CHRISTIANS.

When the Chinese honeysuckle is in bloom, every one near it knows it. If it is in the garden, the tired traveller on the highway, though he may not see it for the wall, knows it is near by its peculiar fragrance; and when we approach the house where it clings to the trellis on the sunny side of the porch, it welcomes us with its breath of sweetness.

Once, while the Saviour was here, because of the violence of his enemies He "went into the borders of Tyre and Sidon, and entered into an house, and would have no man know it: but He could not be hid." Surely not. If we cannot hide the honeysuckle, how can we hope to hide the "rose of Sharon and the lily of the valley?" And neither can we hide ourselves from the world when once we have fully imbibed the spirit of our Christ. Peter and John lived so close to Him that the people among whom they mingled "took knowledge of them that they had been with Jesus."—*M. M. Davis*.

Plain Talks to Plain People.

(BY A PLAIN MAN.)

THE SECOND ADVENT.

In last month's talk I emphasised the necessity for holding a "sound" belief in regard to the Second Advent. The important place that the doctrine occupies in the Scriptures demands this, but, as already pointed out, diverse and opposing opinions are held with respect to (a) The Time, (b) The Nature, and (c) The Purpose of our Lord's Return. This should not be so, seeing that all our knowledge concerning this event is derived from the one source, viz., the Bible. God has spoken. What He has said is truth. Therefore, if we accept what God has said and obtain our knowledge from His words, we are bound to have a sound and uniform belief, and all differences will cease to exist, because Truth will hold the field.

Let us, then, turn our attention to what God has caused to be written for our instruction. Let us endeavour, during our study, to free our minds from all human theories that the Truth may imprint itself deeply upon our hearts.

A great many of the differences that exist in regard to the Time of the Second Advent will disappear when we understand what the Bible teaches in respect to "The Nature and The Purpose of His Return." We will therefore consider these points first.

When the disciples witnessed the ascension of Jesus, an angel appeared to them and said: "Ye men of Galilee, why stand ye looking unto heaven? This same Jesus which was received up from you into heaven shall so come in like manner as ye beheld him going into heaven."—Acts i. 10. This message would no doubt recall to their minds the words of Jesus Himself: "And if I go away and prepare a place for you, I come again and receive you unto myself."—John xiv. 3.

It was the same Jesus who had lived among them, who had spoken these words to them, who had been crucified, who had been raised from the dead that had gone away and that was to come again. His life, His death, His resurrection, His ascension were each and all literal events. Whatever His going away was, His coming again would be that action reversed. It was Jesus in corporeal form that had gone away, and the angel's words could only mean that it will be Jesus in corporeal form that shall return.

Such was the belief that the angel's message implanted in the hearts of the Apostles. This is proved by Peter's words to the people assembled in Solomon's Porch. "Repent ye therefore . . . that so there may come seasons of refreshing from the presence of the Lord; and that He may send the Christ, who hath been appointed for you, even Jesus."—Acts iii. 19 and 20.

The disciples never altered in this belief. That their belief was sound is evident from the fact that they had received the gift of the Holy Spirit that was to lead them into all the truth. Hence if our belief is to be sound we must, like them, look forward to a literal return in corporeal form of Jesus Christ.

We pass on to consider the Purpose of the Second Advent.

In I. Cor. xv. 23 Paul states that The Resurrection will take place at the Coming of Christ. (See also in I. Thess. iv. 16-17). As Christ has not returned in bodily form it is evident that the dead are not yet raised. Thus the contention that Christ comes to all at death is seen to be unsound. One purpose of the Second Advent of Christ is that He may raise the dead to life. The same writer in the same scripture throws further light on the matter in vv. 24-25. "Then cometh the end, when He—Christ—shall deliver up the kingdom to God, even the Father, when He—Christ—shall have abolished all rule, and all authority and power. For He must reign, till He hath put all His enemies under His feet."

It was while Jesus was on earth that He said, "I go away and come again." This is conclusive as to the place to which He shall return. It is to the earth. It is, therefore, on the earth that He shall reign. One of the Purposes, then, of His Second Advent is that He may reign on the earth, and during that reign to put down all rule, authority and power that He may bring "all things in subjection under His feet." v. 27. It is clear that enemies of Christ will be existent on the earth when He returns, which fact effectually disposes of the idea that Christ will come to receive a converted world from the hands of the Church. It also establishes the truth that He shall come to set up "the Kingdom of Heaven" on earth. From Rev. xx. 4 and 6, we learn that Christ shall reign for 1000 years. At the end of that period the earth and all its inhabitants shall be wholly subject to the laws of Heaven, and then shall He hand over "the kingdom" to God, even the Father, that He may be all in all.

In His Sermon on Olivet, Christ answered several questions put to Him by the disciples. Among them was the following one: "What shall be the sign of Thy coming?" (Matt. xxiv. 3). In replying to that question Jesus told them that a time of great tribulation "such as hath not been from the beginning of the world until now, no, nor ever shall be." v. 21. In v. 29 He foretells that terrible convulsions of nature shall immediately follow the tribulation, and then in v. 30 He said: "Then shall appear the sign of the Son of Man in Heaven, and then shall all the tribes of the earth mourn, and they shall see the Son of Man coming on the cloud of heaven with power and great glory." Christ's own words show that the belief that the world will be converted to the Will of Heaven at the time of the Second Advent is unsound, and lead to the acceptance of the truth that the dear Lord will come back at the hour of earth's sorest need and distress that He may overthrow all evil and destroy the works of the devil, and establish the Kingdom of Heaven over all the earth.

WATTHEARE.

A PRAYER.

'Midst all the noise and din of war,
'Midst doubt, and care, and strife,
And voices calling us afar
To sacrifice of life—

May His own Spirit stay with me
That Christ might gain the victory.

—W.H.W.

"The Bible Standard retains its interest and, I hope, has extended usefulness in store."—J.N., Edinburgh.

Short Papers on Important Subjects.

THE GOLDEN AGE, AS SKETCHED BY ISAIAH.

"The vision of Isaiah which he saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem."—Is. i. 1.

Isaiah has what we may call his local prophecies, his "burdens" or oracles concerning Babylon, Moab, Damascus, Egypt, Tyre, Dumah and Arabia (as chap. xxi. 1, 11, 13), but when he writes of Judah and Jerusalem, the supernaturally strengthened eye of the seer pierces the long dark centuries of his country's desolation and his countrymen's wanderings in far-off lands, and his pen records what in vision is shown him, i.e., the last days, the restoration of his people from their long banishment, their national happiness and glory under the magnificent reign of the Prince of Peace. And the whole revelation might be summed up in that pregnant sentence, "The Lord of Hosts shall reign in Mount Zion and in Jerusalem, and before His ancients gloriously" (xxiv. 23). Isaiah is pre-eminently the poet-prophet of the Kingdom of Christ upon earth. In glowing words and with unfaltering certainty, he sings of the glory which shall be revealed, but it is the personal presence of the Lord which constitutes that glory. "And it shall come to pass in the latter days that Jehovah's house shall be exalted and all nations shall flow unto it, for out of Zion shall go forth the law, and the word of Jehovah from Jerusalem. And He shall rule among the nations, neither shall they learn war any more" (ii. 1-4). That none of these most blessed things have as yet taken place is, alas! too obvious, for Zion is to-day a desolation under Turkish rule, Jerusalem is trodden under foot by German soldiery, and the greatest war the world has ever seen is now being waged by the leading nations of Europe. Isaiah, moreover, reveals that idolatry is absolutely to cease, that China and Japan, India and Africa, shall cast away all idols of silver and gold, "and Jehovah alone shall be exalted in that day" (ii. 10-22).

It is most interesting to learn that during the millennial age, the city of Jerusalem—its inhabitants having been purged from their sins, will be visibly overshadowed and guarded by the glory cloud, as was the tabernacle of Moses and the temple of Solomon. "Jehovah will create over the whole habitation of Mount Zion, a cloud by day, and the shining of a flaming fire by night, yea, over all shall the Glory be as a covering" (iv. 2-6). And this glory is closely connected with the exaltation of the son of David. "For unto us a child is born, and His name shall be called the Prince of Peace. Of the increase of His government and place there shall be no end: upon the throne of David, and upon His Kingdom, to establish it with judgment and justice for ever" (ix. 5-6). The angel's word to Mary settles of whom Isaiah spoke (Luke i. 32-33), and if confirmation was needed, John in his gospel informs us that Isaiah "saw Christ's glory" (xii. 41), evidently referring to the wonderful vision vouchsafed to that prophet of a scene which, in all its reality, is yet to be, and which we find recorded in Is. vi. 1-3.

At that happy period, too, the animal creation shall share in the jubilee of peace, the wild denizens

of the forest and the jungle shall lose their ferocity, and the very reptiles that once carried deadly poison shall be perfectly harmless. The prophet tells how the wolf, the leopard, the lion and the bear shall be on terms of amity with the lamb, the kid, the calf and the cow (xi. 6-9). Do not attempt to spiritualise this celebrated prophecy. Some think it is only figurative, and sets forth how a fierce, lion-like man can be converted and become as gentle as a lamb, and so on. But our reverence for the exact words of inspiration forbids our tampering with their evident meaning. And besides, in the very next (10th) verse we have the blessed effects of Christ's reign over human beings described. So we need not rob the lower animals of their blessing. We accept both descriptions in their full literal meaning. We understand the place and use of metaphors when we meet with them. But we protest against that fatal system of interpretation called "spiritualising," which as a robber takes away the Key of Knowledge, and casts a veil of thick darkness over much scripture which professes to reveal the future.

Isaiah evidently believed in the literality of all the foregoing, for he composed a song which Israel should sing "in that day." His twelfth chapter is that song, a gem of rarest lustre, a divine brilliant, casting its rays in every direction. The brief chapter closes with these jubilant words, "Sing unto the Lord, for He hath wrought a stupendous work: this is made manifest in all the earth. Cry aloud and shout for joy, thou inhabitant of Zion: for great in the midst of thee is the Holy One of Israel." (Lowth's trans.).

But before the Golden Age shall commence the great Gentile World power which began with Nebuchadnezzar and Babylon shall cease to exist. True is it that Babylon shall be rebuilt and become the great Eastern Emporium of the nations, the Royal Residence of "the man of sin," i.e., the Anti-Christ. But Isaiah in chaps. xiii. and xiv. describes the terrible fate that overtakes this wicked city. "It shall be as when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah. It shall never again be inhabited, neither shall the Arabian pitch his tent there" (ver. 19-20). This prophecy has never been fulfilled. Thousands of persons inhabit the Babylonian plains, and the Arabs there just recently helped to defeat a British army. The destruction of Babylon and the rebuilding of Jerusalem are future events, and both connected with the coming "Day of the Lord" (xiii. 6, 9, 13; xiv. 3). "The Lord will have compassion on Jacob, and set them in their own land" (xiv. 1-3). "Jehovah God of hosts hath decreed; and who shall disannul it? And it is His hand that is stretched out, and who shall turn it back?" (xiv. 26, 27). There is no hesitant speech here, no contingency, but, on the contrary, the prophet declares what shall be done and throws out a challenge to the universe to prevent it.

One of the blessed effects of the study of these Divine prophecies is that it invigorates faith, braces and strengthens the mind, gives the calmness of certainty as to the ultimate destruction of all the enemies of God, and the final triumph of truth and righteousness in our world. "It shall be done, for the Lord hath spoken" (Ez. xii. 28), is the animating lesson with which one rises from the perusal of these glorious descriptions of the future.

Devonport.

CARPUS.

(To be concluded.)

Corner for Boys and Girls.

My Dear Young Nephews and Nieces,—

Last month we were thinking about the young boy who lived in the time of Elijah the prophet, and we noticed the one great thing that came into his young life, that daily miracle which taught him the daily care that the great God shows for all His creatures.

This month, however, we will talk of a little girl who lived not long afterward, and who also had something to do with a great miracle, but in quite a different way.

All we are told of her is found in two small verses, and yet I think of all the girls mentioned in the Bible this one must have been one of the nicest. In those two verses in the fifth chapter of the Second Book of Kings we learn something of her sad history, and we can almost picture the sad tragedy that tore her from her home.

We can imagine her happy home in some quiet country village, where she was growing up surrounded by her loved friends and playmates. One day, however, alarming tidings are brought in by a frightened peasant. "The Syrians are coming," and those who can attempt escape, rush away, leaving all behind. Perhaps a few brave men attempt defence, but are slain in the vain attempt to beat off that great band of well-armed raiders. Perhaps the little maid's father so fell, or her brothers, if she had any. Did her mother manage to escape? The attack is soon complete, and then the fierce, strange warriors search the village for anything valuable and drive together all the cattle in the fields. The wounded who are able to walk are made to march away to captivity, while those too badly hurt are left to die. The women, and boys and girls who have been unable to escape are banded together and made to go with the other captives. What a sad picture is hinted at in that single verse; the captives, the spoil, the driven animals, and a strange land and people in the future, while behind them a ruined and desolate home. The little maid after that long, weary march is sent to the house of a great Syrian general, and one wonders why she was selected for this great house. Perhaps even on that long, trying journey she had tried to make the best of the terrible time, and kept up her brave little heart, and so she, as the best of the plunder, is given to the loved general's wife, to be her slave.

In that new, strange land she quickly learned that she was not the only one in trouble, for here in this large house there was great sadness, because the master, loved and greatly honoured, was condemned to be driven soon from home and loved ones; deprived of his usefulness and honour, not because of anything he had done, but because of the dreadful disease which had fallen on him.

His case was helpless and hopeless. Not even the thousands of that general's brave troops could drive off the terrible enemy of disease. Only God could do this, and the great soldier did not know of Him who had done such wonderful things through His servants in the land of Israel. The little maid knew of Him, but was it any use speaking of Him, for had He not permitted her home to be broken up, her life spoiled and her family scattered? Could she believe in a good Heavenly Father after all that, and could she speak of Him? The story

tells that she could and did. Perhaps she remembered that the prophet had told them that one of the things that would come upon their land and people if they forgot God would be an invasion by fierce enemies, and perhaps that thoughtful little maid reasoned that the same sad things that had happened to her were really proofs that God was true.

With sympathy for others in trouble she told her mistress of the help that might be had in the land of Israel at the hand of the servant of God.

It was a wonderful thing that this little girl did; she sowed the seed of a mighty faith in that great man, and he set off on that long journey into an unfriendly land (though they were not actually at war then) to ask for this help from God at the hand of His servant.

Why, there were many lepers in Israel, right near to that source of help, and not one of them, though they heard of and knew of Elisha's great deeds, had ever had the faith to ask for God's blessing through him.

The little girl had sent Naaman, she was so sure it would be all right. You know the rest of the story. How Naaman came with his horses and chariot and his servants. Did he think that it was just as well to take a large force in case the King of Israel should take a fancy for making him a prisoner? He would have made a good hostage and would be quite a prize, seeing he was the Syrians' best general.

We know how he came as a leper and went back well, though he very nearly lost the blessing because of want of obedience.

We do not hear any more of that little girl through whom he had got back his precious health. What was her reward? Was she sent back home with honours, or was she given position and freedom and honour in that strange land?

If she had neither of these, yet she would be glad to know that she had done good, and she had at least brought one to know something of God and to honour His name.

Would it not be a grand thing if we boys and girls could so get to love and trust our Heavenly Father, that if even sorrow and trouble as bad as came to this little girl were our lot, we would still know Him to be good and be ready to point others to seek His help. Well, the best way to get that confidence and love is to read and learn His word while all our life is fair before us.

Now, in regard to the answers received last month. They were again few, and I am wondering whether it is that extra halfpenny stamp that must go on letters that is keeping some of my young friends from writing to me. I am sure the last work I gave you was not very hard. Good answers came from Florence Lewis, Newton; and Dorothy Whiteside, of Raupo; and Milton and Hazel Ashby, of Petone.

Florence has sent in the best paper, though it is her first time of writing to me. The word was "Gratitude" and was made up of the first letters from Grace, Ruth, Atonement, Truth, Immortality, Thanks, Understanding, Daniel, Ebenezer.

Now I am giving something a little harder this month. Here is a word of thirteen letters, and to find out what it is you must take the first letter of the answer you get to the first question, and the second letter of the second answer, the first letter of the third one, and the second of the fourth, and so on, and you will find a word which covers a sub-

ject which Paul wrote about, a subject which appears difficult when you read its long name, but which is really quite simple to understand. I wonder if you can tell me something about it in a few words. As you know, I send a prize for the best attempt.

Won't some of our new readers try as well as our old friends?

Answer to UNCLE DAN, 22 Brentwood Avenue, Mt. Eden.

1. Who was the friend that gave his love,
To him that might a rival prove?
2. What physician, who for friendship proved,
Was named by Paul as "much beloved?"
3. Who was he who once espied
Honey in a lion's side?
4. Who he, possessed of Godly gifts so rare,
Was early called a martyr's death to bear?
5. From what city did the Apostle Paul
Flee from plotting Jews and Gentiles all?
6. What is it that a man may have to bear,
Who hopes the victor's crown of life to wear?
7. A land to which the soldiers tall,
In strange ship took the preacher Paul.
8. A field, deserted, what's its name,
Where to his death a traitor came?
9. A city, for a small thing famed,
Believers here were Christians named.
10. A bodyguard in which was one
Who for good deeds and alms was known.
11. A man whose hand 'twas said would be
Held 'gainst all men in enmity.
12. Who she, of whom the Scriptures speak,
Did garments make for poor and weak?
13. What was the city, much despised,
Whence could be hoped-for nothing prized?

WAIHI CHURCH OF CHRIST SUNDAY SCHOOL ANNIVERSARY AND SOCIAL.

The sun of March 26 brought our S.S. Anniversary and fine weather. The building was brightened by tasteful grouping of flags and greenery, testifying to the decorative work of Superintendent W. Hawke and his sons.

Sister Donaldson, in the threefold role of vocalist, organist and conductress, educed from the scholars their best vocal efforts; Elsie Hall and Ellie Bestie rendered solos in a pleasing manner.

Bro. Foster, in his afternoon and evening addresses, held the attention and interest of the children, and in every way our Anniversary of 1916 was a success, mainly due to the untiring efforts of Sister Donaldson.

Following as a pleasing sequel came the S.S. Social, when prizes were distributed, a programme by the scholars presented, and refreshments appeased hungry and thirsty people, old and young.

J.M., Secretary.

"I take the liberty of expressing my appreciation of the B.S., and hope its timely messages will continue to be sent forth until our blessed Lord returns."—A.M., South Australia.

Church and Mission News.

AUCKLAND.

As we meet, week by week, in order to remember together the death of our Lord Jesus, we have, during the month just ended, also commemorated the glorious fact that He rose again, and that now He is alive for evermore, a fact that is of the greatest importance to all who would follow in His footsteps.

During the course of Bible talks by Bro. Geo. Aldridge upon the "Holy Spirit" at the Wednesday evening class, increased interest has been shown by members and friends, who have attended in large numbers, and obtained much blessing as a result. Whilst many have benefited, there are not a few who have expressed regret at being unable to attend these meetings. We are hopeful that the added interest which is now evident in the mid-week Bible Class will be sustained as the weeks go by.

The Sunday night Prayer Meeting is being held for a brief quarter-hour after the evening service, upon the third Sunday each month, and all believers are earnestly requested to draw apart at these times, prayerfully uniting for the common good.

We have bidden farewell to Bro. Walter Fowler, who will be missed from his accustomed place in the Choir, as well as from the Church membership. Bro. Fowler has enlisted, and will in a few weeks proceed from these shores in his country's cause.

During the month we have had the following visitors and friends in fellowship:—Sister Stephens, of Lower Ruakaka; Sis. Firth, senior, of Oratia; Sis. Madge Taylor and Sis. Robinson, of Thames; Bro. and Sis. Walker, from Buckland; Bro. and Sis. Cates, of Kumeu; Bro. LeRoy, Great Barrier; Sis. Tuck, of Hamilton; and Sis. Bishop, Manurewa.

S.C.

PAEROA.

At the last meeting held Sunday, April 9th, there were sixteen adults present and several children. Others are interested and have expressed their intention of attending the services. A debt of gratitude is owing to Bro. Salisbury for his willing help. We believe that all who have attended the meetings have been drawn into a closer fellowship with God.

M.L.

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TRUST ALSO.

"Commit thy way unto the Lord; trust also in Him and He shall bring it to pass."—Psalm xxxvii. 5.

(BY WILLIAM LUFF.)

"Commit thy way unto the Lord and trust!"

Ah! it is here we fail. We give the wheel
Of our small barque to Him: but then we thrust

Our hand upon His hand,

And dare to stand

Beside our Master, lest He wreck our keel.

"Commit thy way unto the Lord and trust,"

Leave all to Him: believe He knows thy course,
Thy dangers and thy safety—all—then just

Abandon all to Him,

So shalt thou skim

Borne briskly on before the Spirit's force.

"Commit thy way unto the Lord and trust"

There is an "Also" we too oft forget,
And so are plagued and worried. Oh! we must

"Trust also," then our soul

Shall cease to roll

In restlessness, and reason, and regret.

Commit, and when committed, trust His word;

Has He not said that He will bring you through?

Trust His strong arm: and when wild storms are
heard,

Believe He holds them still

By His strong will,

Trust Him the Wise, the Faithful, and the True.

Trust Him to manage all that thou dost now

Commit to Him: the ship, the sails, the sea,

The sailors, thy strange crew, and ask not how

He will do all for thee,

But trustful be,

Lie down and rest from anxious worry free.

"Your writers write as if they had something
worth while saying, and not for the mere sake of
filling space allotted."—H.L., Christchurch.

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THE BIBLE STANDARD.

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to the Secretary, MR. ALEX. PAGE, Murdoch Road,
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The "Bible Standard" can be ordered direct from the
Treasurer, CHARLES F. GARRATT, Aratonga Avenue,
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CHURCH OF CHRIST.

Hold Services as under:

AUCKLAND—West Street. Sunday, 11 a.m., Fellow-
ship Meeting; 6.45 p.m., Preaching Service. Sunday
School, 2.45.

Wednesday evening, Bible Class, at 7.45.

Evangelist's Address—Geo. Aldridge, 22, Brentwood
Avenue, Mt. Eden. Telephone No. 1417.

Secretary—Andrew Thomson, Chamberlain Street, Grey
Lynn.

WALTERS ROAD AND EMMA STREET—Sunday, at
11 a.m., Fellowship Meeting. Sunday School, at
2.45 p.m. Preaching Service, 6.45 p.m.

Evangelist—Thos. Southworth, Croydon Road, off Dominion
Road.

HAMILTON—Claudelands.

Sunday, at 11 a.m., Fellowship Meeting.

Sunday, at 7 p.m., Preaching.

Evangelist—Horace W. Milner, Claudelands.

Secretary—A. Pearson, Claudelands.

HELENSVILLE—Church, Sunday, Fellowship Meeting.
11 a.m.; Sunday School, 2.30. Sunday evening,
Preaching, 7.

Church Secretary—A. J. Skelton.

THAMES—Pollen Street.

Sunday, at 11 a.m., Fellowship Meeting.

Sunday School, 2.30; Evening Service, 6.30.

Tuesday evening, Christian Band, 7.30.

Wednesday Evening, Bible Class, at 7.30.

Evangelist—Chas. Waterhouse, Edward Street.

Secretary—Chas. Sanders, Macky Street.

WAIHI—Church, Main Street.

Sunday, 11 a.m., Fellowship Meeting.

Sunday, 2.30 p.m., Sunday School.

Sunday Evening, at 7, a Public Address.

Church Secretary—D. Donaldson.

Evangelist—Joseph Foster, Waihi.

HASTINGS, HAWKE'S BAY—

Sunday, at 11 a.m., in the Old Library Hall, for
Fellowship, Breaking of Bread, and Address.

Acting Secretary's Address—J. W. Walker, Boundary
Road, Hastings.

OHURA, KING COUNTRY—

Sunday, Fellowship Meeting, 11 a.m. Visitors wel-
comed.—A. Wallace Thompson.

DUNEDIN—Corner Moray Place and Filleul Street.
Sunday, 11 a.m., Fellowship Meeting; 6.30 p.m.,
Preaching Service. Sunday School at 2.45 p.m.

Wednesday evening, 7.45, Bible Class and Prayer
Meeting.

Church Secretary—S. A. Lawrence, 6, Hope Street.

ADELAIDE, S.A.—Miss L. L. Blackeby, 226, Rundle
Street.

Printed by the Brett Printing and Publishing Company,
Shortland Street, for the New Zealand Evangelistic
and Publication Association (Incorporated), and pub-
lished by CHARLES F. GARRATT, Aratonga Avenue,
One-tree Hill, Auckland.—MAY, 1916.